HSBC Global Investment Research

27 April 2026

Lithium

Hanging in the balance

Equities
Metals & Mining

Global

- Lithium prices to remain elevated driven by supply disruptions and strong ESS demand
- The market to remain tight in the near term despite Zimbabwe to move to a quota system instead of a full ban
- Maintain Buy rating on SQM, ALB and LAR and Hold on LAC; revise TPs

Lithium prices to remain strong in the near term: The rally in lithium prices, during the past ten months, was driven by strong demand and supply disruptions. The announced ban on concentrate exports from Zimbabwe curtailed supply and boosted prices during the past couple of months.

The Zimbabwe government's decision to adopt a quota system provides respite, but risks still exist: In April 2026, the country changed its decision of a complete ban on exports of mineral concentrate and decided to introduce quotas for export of lithium concentrates with certain conditions. Our base case is for exports to be resumed for the remaining months of 2026 but the export quotas from 2027 to be only issued to the companies building lithium sulphate capacity in the country. Thus, we have cut our supply estimates by c40kt for 2026 and c68kt in 2027 from Zimbabwe. However, we highlight risk of procedural delays in issuing quotas which could hamper shipments from the country. Reflecting the tighter near-term balance, we revised our 2026-27 lithium prices higher (*Metals quarterly* 13 April 2026).

ESS driving demand; potential shift towards EVs could boost demand: While EV demand visibility remains uncertain, demand for lithium remains robust driven by rapid growth in energy storage systems (ESS), with lithium demand forecast to grow 19% y-o-y in 2026 and at a 13% CAGR through 2030. There is a speculation regarding the potential impact of higher energy prices on EV adoption. While it is a little early to suggest this will result in structural shift towards EVs, our analysis suggests one percent increases (each) in BEV and PHEV penetration rates will results in a 3% increase in total lithium demand.

Maintain Buy rating on SQM, ALB and LAR and Hold on LAC: We prefer **SQM** due to its operational excellence, strong balance sheet, and volume growth. We believe **ALB**'s continuous efforts to control costs and efficiency gains position it to benefit from higher lithium prices. The continuous improvement in production at **LAR**'s Cauchari Olaroz operations indicates operational stability.

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Key changes to ratings and estimates

Company	Ticker	Currency	Current price	TP Old	TP New	Rating Old	Rating New	Upside/ downside	Market cap (USDm)	3m ADTV (USDm)	2026e EV/EBITDA	2027e EV/EBITDA	2026e PE
SQM	SQM US	USD	86.95	95.00	100.00	Buy	Buy	15.0%	25,721	112	9.4	9.6	18.2
Albemarle	ALB US	USD	194.22	200.00	220.00	Buy	Buy	13.3%	22,896	438	10.5	12.8	26.3
Lithium Argentina	LAR US	USD	9.25	9.60	10.25	Buy	Buy	10.8%	1,516	2	22.3	32.9	25.1
Lithium Americas	LAC US	USD	4.99	6.30	4.75	Hold	Hold	-4.8%	1,734	51	nm	nm	nm

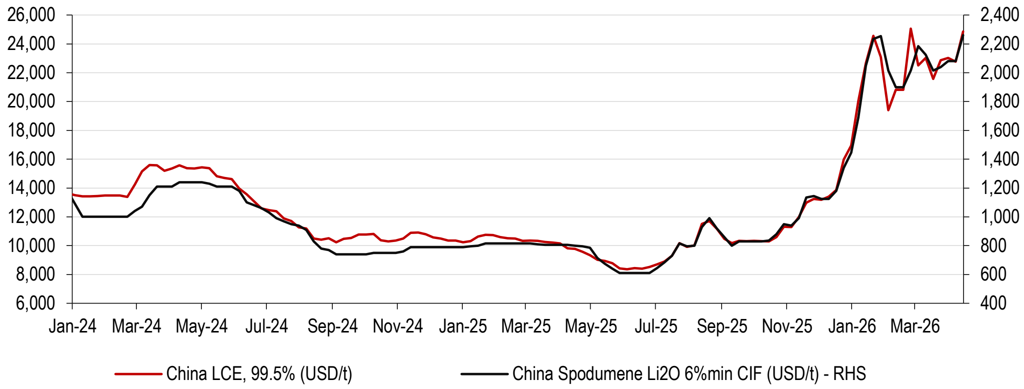
Source: HSBC estimates. Priced as of close of 22 Apr 2026

Lithium prices remain elevated

Lithium carbonate (BG China) prices are up c303% from the June 2025 trough

Lithium carbonate (BG China) prices are up c303% from the June 2025 trough. Spodumene prices are up c292%, also from trough levels. Year-to-date, lithium carbonate prices are up c44% and spodumene prices are up c52%. The rally in lithium prices during the past ten months was driven by strong demand and supply disruptions. The announced ban on concentrate exports from Zimbabwe curtailed supply and boosted prices during the past couple of months.

Lithium prices maintaining its strength



Source: Bloomberg, HSBC

Supply disruptions pose an upside risk

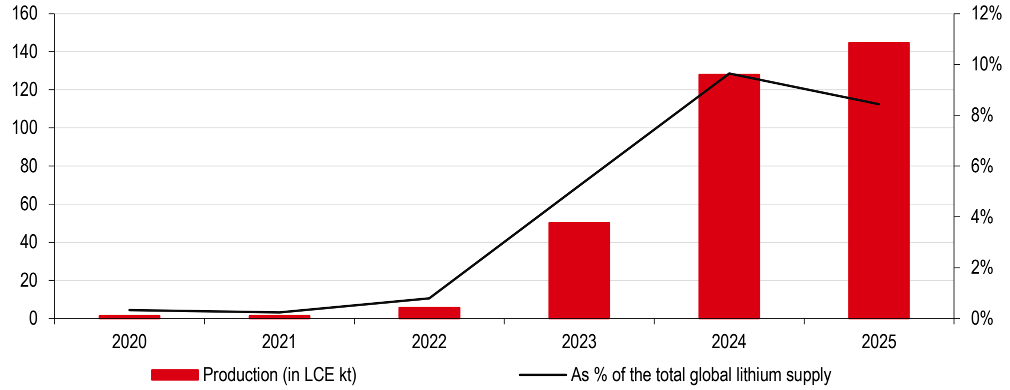
In February 2026, Zimbabwe's government announced a ban on export of mineral concentrates from the country effective 26 February 2026. The announcement caused a significant risk to the lithium supply chain as Zimbabwe represented c8% of the global lithium supply in 2025. The majority of spodumene produced in Zimbabwe is owned by Chinese companies and exported to China for further processing.

The announcement of a ban on exports of concentrate was not surprising, but the timing caught us off guard. The previous plan was to curb exports of lithium concentrates from January 2027. Since 2022, Zimbabwe's government has been asking producers to set-up domestic processing capabilities and curb illegal mining.

In April 2026, the Zimbabwe's government announced a plan to introduce quotas for export of concentrates instead of a full ban, and allow resumption of concentrate exports with certain conditions including commitments to construct lithium sulphate processing capacities.

Currently there is c110-120kt LCE of lithium sulphate capacity under construction in the country, but we do not expect all plants to be operational in 2026. China's Zhejiang Huayou Cobalt's new 50ktpa lithium sulphate plant is the only one to be operational in 2026.

Lithium concentrate production in Zimbabwe has grown rapidly in the recent years



Source: Wood Mackenzie, HSBC estimates

Our base case is for exports to be resumed for the remaining months of 2026 but the export quotas from 2027 to be only issued to the companies building lithium sulphate capacity in the country

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While our base case is a resumption of exports and a shift to the quota system, we highlight the transition to a new quota system might not be smooth. We have seen similar constraints put in place by other countries and observed procedural delays leading to lower shipments. DRC adopted a quota system for exports of cobalt in September 2025, following a seven month ban on exports. However, due to procedural issues miners in the country could not export volumes approved under the 4Q25 quota even in 1Q26. We highlight a risk of lower lithium concentrate shipments from Zimbabwe even after the quotas are allocated. The ban on exports of lithium concentrates for effectively two months and potential delays in resuming exports from Zimbabwe should keep the physical market tight in the near term.

The restarts will not mitigate the impact

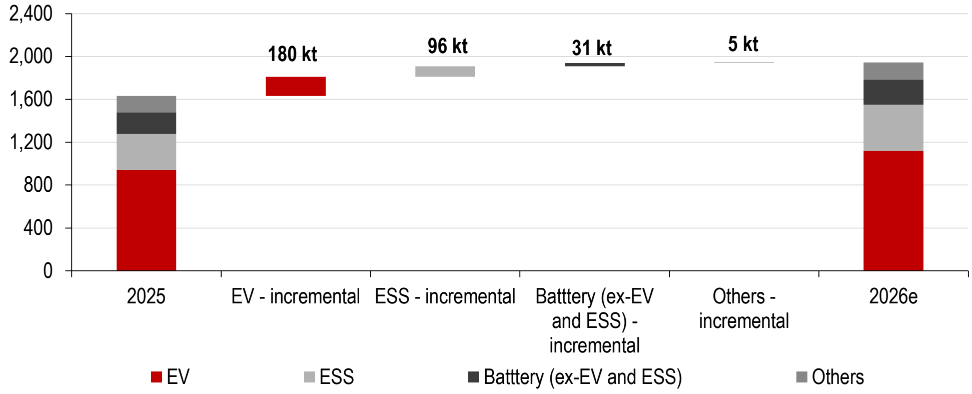
PLS has announced its plan to restart its 200ktpa Ngungaju spodumene plant at its Pilgangoora operation in July 2026. During its 1H26 results, Mineral Resources also indicated that it is evaluating a restart of its Bald Hill operations, which was shut down in 2024 due to difficult market conditions. While the Ngungaju plant is expected to restart in July 26, the final decision on a restart of Bald Hill is still pending, and thus it is not included in our base case. We highlight the process of restarting operations will take time and once announced there will be a ramp-up period. If restarted in 2H26, we estimate these two operations could add c15-20kt and 35-40kt LCE in 2026 and 2027 LCE.

That said, the incremental volumes from these two operations will not be enough to meet the shortfall in production from the reduction in supply from Zimbabwe.

Demand to remain strong

We expect lithium demand to grow 19% y-o-y in 2026e and at a CAGR of 13% during 2026e-2030e. EV and ESS are the key drivers of lithium demand. The post Chinese-New-Year restocking has accelerated amid expectations of higher prices, supported by stronger battery output and the upcoming reduction in export VAT rebates. In March, lithium battery production reached 219GWh (+c17% m-o-m) in China, with ESS accounting for c41% of output. We forecast global LCE demand from ESS to increase c29% y-o-y in 2026, with its share of the total demand rising from 19% in 2025 to c22% in 2026, supporting overall global lithium demand growth of c19% y-o-y.

EV + ESS key driver for lithium demand



Source: HSBC estimates

We address some of the key concerns/questions which could impact lithium demand in the near or long term.

1. How is an increase in lithium prices impacting battery costs and demand dynamics?
The battery supply chain is better placed as compared to the last upcycle in lithium prices (in 2021-2022). Although there appears to be no easy fix to the EV battery oversupply in the short term, HSBC analysts believe the oversupply peaked in 2025, and multiple factors, including production cuts, project delays, and conversion to ESS, should ease the oversupply.

Another key difference is the pass-through mechanism established by battery producers, especially for raw materials like lithium; this has improved post the last upcycle in lithium. HSBC China auto analysts highlight the pass-through rate depends on the relative bargaining power and product price elasticity, e.g., overseas products tolerate cost increases better, while domestic mass-market EV and some storage batteries might face more resistance. (See *CATL-A/H: Buy/Buy: FAQs – How to gauge raw materials price fluctuations*, 2 March 2026).

An increase of USD10/kg in lithium prices translates into an increase of cUSD380-440 and cUSD160-190 for the cost of a BEV and PHEV, respectively

We estimate an average requirement of 0.63kg/kwh of LCE for batteries. An increase of USD10/kg in lithium prices translates into an increase of USD6.3/kwh. With an average battery capacity per vehicle of c60-70kWh for a full BEV and c25-30kWH for PHEV, this translates into an increase of cUSD380-440 and cUSD160-190 for the cost of a BEV and PHEV, respectively, representing just c1-2% of the vehicle cost in China.

Analysis of increase in EV/PHEV cost from the increase in lithium prices

		BEV	PHEV
Lithium carbonate usage	kg/kWH	0.63	0.63
Increase in lithium price	USD/kg	10	10
Average battery capacity	kWH	60-70	25-30
Increase in costs	USD	**378-441**	**158-189**

Source: HSBC estimates

2. Opportunities for EV and ESS in the crisis?
Carmakers have produced EVs (ex-China) that are biased toward the top-end of their model ranges and, more importantly, priced them above their ICE equivalents. According to IEA, the average price premium for small battery electric cars in Germany remained almost unchanged between 2021 and 2023, plateauing at over 50% more than equivalent small ICE models. In the US, about four in five electric SUVs (including pick-up trucks) in 2024 were sold at a higher price than the average conventional SUV. This is particularly significant given that SUVs account for three-quarters of total car sales in the country.

EVs have become mainstream in China but they are lagging in Europe and lesser policy support in the US under the current administration. One of the major differences between China and the other two markets is that EVs have enjoyed a pull effect from customers in China (it helps that they were cheaper/better than ICE vehicles) whereas in the EU and US, EV penetration has needed a push effect driven mainly by regulations and government funded purchase incentives/tax breaks.

Higher fuel prices could be fuelling interest in EVs but it's a little early to suggest this will result in a structural shift

There is an increase in speculation regarding the potential impact of higher energy prices on consumer demand and to what degree it might provide an impetus to EV adoption. The rise in oil prices could improve consumer sentiments towards owning EVs as total cost of owning an ICE vehicle will increase. At the same time, energy scarcity could also result in higher electricity prices increasing total cost of owning an EV. Given volatility and uncertainty in oil and electricity prices, it is difficult, at this time, to ascertain which one will be more economical in the long term.

That said, there is also a possibility that potential fuel shortages might lead to a change in consumer preference, especially in emerging markets, and boost EV adoption. Energy security has become a priority for most governments. Governments could potentially encourage EV adoption in order to cut oil consumption, especially countries that are net importers of oil.

Consumers might respond with a lag, and near-term auto demand can still be shaped by macro factors. HSBC auto analysts believe it is unclear whether the ongoing increase in oil would translate to higher orders as EV company web traffic data show no noticeable spike. The team highlights economics of EV ownership has turned favourable, but other issues like charging infrastructure and used values are decision factors (see *Global Autos - Middle East Conflict: To EV or not to EV*, 1 April 2025).

In the below scenario, we analysed the impact of an increase in penetration rates for BEVs and PHEVs by one percent (each) as compared to our base case. We have assumed no change to our total passenger vehicle volumes forecast.

Based on our analysis, one percent (each) increase in penetration rates of BEV and PHEV will result in 3% increase in lithium demand

Based on our analysis, one percent increase (each) in penetration rates of BEV and PHEV will result in a 3% increase in total lithium demand.

Scenario analysis: Analysing the impact of increase in BEV and PHEV penetration on the lithium demand

	2026		2027		2028		2029		2030	
In LCE kt	Absolute increase (kt)	as % of total demand	Absolute increase (kt)	as % of total demand	Absolute increase (kt)	as % of total demand	Absolute increase (kt)	as % of total demand	Absolute increase (kt)	as % of total demand
Incremental lithium demand	67	3%	69	3%	72	3%	73	3%	77	3%

Source: HSBC estimates

ESS is emerging as the industry's key growth pillar driven by the decline in the cost of energy storage, greater renewables penetration, improving policy support, electricity demand growth, and the AI data centre boom.

Since 2010, lithium-ion battery pack costs have declined c90% due to the ramp-up in battery cell manufacturing, lower raw material prices and technological advancements. As a result of the sharp decline in battery pack prices, battery storage is becoming increasingly competitive with other forms of dispatchable generation.

According to HSBC analysts, most countries, with the exception of China, are yet to achieve solar plus ESS levelized costs of electricity (LCOE) parity with gas power. However, a prolonged Middle East conflict could lead to lower cost competitiveness for gas power. The economics for solar plus ESS (2hrs) against gas power for most places globally will be viable estimate in the event of a repeat of the 2022 gas crisis. See *China Energy Equipment & Services - Prolonged conflict could accelerate renewables adoption*, 10 March 2026.

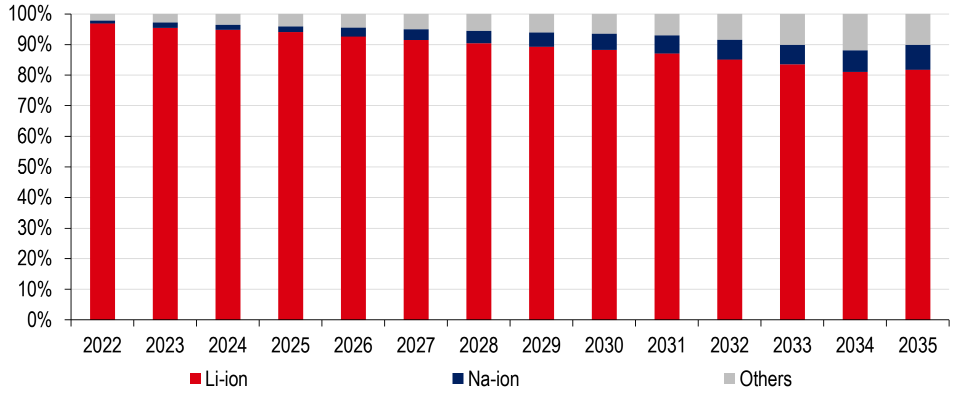
3. Substitution with sodium-ion batteries
Sodium-ion batteries have recently gained traction alongside the rapid increase in ESS deployment as technology advances and lithium prices surged. CATL has launched Naxtra sodium-ion batteries which has achieved an energy density of up to 175 Wh/kg.

Traditionally, when EVs dominated the usage of batteries, sodium-ion batteries faced limitations due to their low energy density. Given sodium ion batteries will be larger and heavier than lithium-ion batteries to achieve the same energy requirement, placing them in EVs will require more space and will add more weight to vehicle. Further improvement in energy density and increased demand from BESS could help to increase adoption of sodium-ion batteries. Furthermore, sodium-ion batteries provide better performance under extreme weather conditions.

Further improvements in energy density and development of supply chain could accelerate mass adoption of sodium-ion batteries

Thus, we could see a pick-up in the use of sodium-ion batteries. Recent demand growth has been concentrated in ESS usage, especially in China where lower energy density is less of a constraint and cost competitiveness is the primary consideration. Further improvements in energy density and development of supply chain could accelerate mass adoption of sodium-ion batteries. According to Wood Mackenzie forecasts, sodium-ion technology market share will grow close to 10% of the global ESS installations in 2035.

ESS installations by technology - share of sodium-ion technology will be close to 10% of the global installations in 2035



Source: Wood Mackenzie; 2022-2024 are actuals, 2025 onwards are estimates

HSBC lithium view

Since 2H25, lithium prices are in an upcycle driven by stronger demand and supply disruptions. In the near term, we expect lithium prices to remain elevated as the physical market remains tight due to loss of supply from Zimbabwe. We highlight possibility of delay in shipments even though the quotas are put in place. Looking into 2H26, as new supply from the restarts gradually comes online and market sentiment normalises, prices may ease but still remain at elevated levels.

We have revised our China BG lithium carbonate price forecasts for 2026/2027 up by 18%/9%

We have revised our China BG lithium carbonate price forecasts for 2026/2027 up by 18%/9%. Further disruptions or stronger-than-expected demand from ESS pose upside risks. (See *Metals Quarterly Q2 2026 - 'Conflict'ed*, 13 April 2026).

HSBC lithium S&D model

in LCE kt	2024	2025	2026e	2027e	2028e	2029e	2030e	Change 2026-30e	CAGR 2026e-30e
Demand									
EVs	707	940	1,120	1,282	1,473	1,665	1,853	912	15%
Battery demand (ex-EV)	415	540	666	745	831	923	1,015	475	13%
Total battery demand	**1,122**	**1,480**	**1,787**	**2,027**	**2,303**	**2,588**	**2,867**	**1,387**	**14%**
y-o-y	*33%*	*32%*	*21%*	*13%*	*14%*	*12%*	*11%*		
Total non-battery demand	149	152	157	162	166	171	177	24	3%
y-o-y	*3%*	*2%*	*3%*	*3%*	*3%*	*3%*	*3%*		
Total demand	**1,271**	**1,632**	**1,944**	**2,188**	**2,470**	**2,759**	**3,044**	**1,412**	**13%**
y-o-y	*29%*	*28%*	*19%*	*13%*	*13%*	*12%*	*10%*		
Supply									
Total refined supply before recycling	1,277	1,646	1,962	2,198	2,400	2,543	2,692	1,046	10%
y-o-y	*38%*	*29%*	*19%*	*12%*	*9%*	*6%*	*6%*		
Recycling	51	68	88	122	170	208	253	185	30%
y-o-y	*41%*	*34%*	*28%*	*40%*	*39%*	*23%*	*22%*		
Total Refined supply	**1,328**	**1,715**	**2,050**	**2,321**	**2,570**	**2,751**	**2,945**	**1,231**	**11%**
y-o-y	*38%*	*29%*	*20%*	*13%*	*11%*	*7%*	*7%*		
Market balance									
Inventory changes	(85)	(25)	35	76	50	29	29		
Surplus / (deficit) post inventory changes	**142**	**108**	**71**	**57**	**51**	**(37)**	**(128)**		

Reproduced from *Metals Quarterly Q2 2026 - 'Conflict'ed*, 13 April 2026
Source: HSBC estimates, USGS, Wood Mackenzie

SQM (SQM US, CMP USD86.95) – maintain Buy; increase TP to USD100 (from USD95)

Investment thesis

We like SQM due to expectations of an increase in volumes, its operational excellence, and strong balance sheet. The ramp up of the Kwinana refinery in Australia and increased volumes in Chile should drive volume growth and improve product mix. The agreement with Codelco removes a key overhang. SQM's realised prices for lithium follow the spot price movement closely and thus provide an upside risk in the event of higher lithium price.

Sensitivity to changes in lithium prices

Lithium prices are volatile, and the stock price shows a high degree of sensitivity to changes in lithium prices. SQM's realised prices follow the spot price movement closely as indicated by our sensitivity analysis in the following table.

Sensitivity to changes in lithium price assumptions

	2026e EBITDA USDm	2027e EBITDA USDm	NAV/shr USD	Change vs base case (%) 2026e EBITDA	2027e EBITDA	NAV/shr
20% lower prices	2,802	2,513	80.00	-13%	-19%	-20%
10% lower prices	3,013	2,800	90.00	-7%	-9%	-10%
Base case	**3,224**	**3,086**	**100.00**			
10% higher prices	3,434	3,373	110.00	7%	9%	10%
20% higher prices	3,645	3,659	119.00	13%	19%	19%

Source: HSBC estimates

Changes to estimates

The increases in our estimates are primarily driven by the increases in our lithium price forecasts.

SQM: Our estimate changes, 2026-28e

USDm, except otherwise noted	New 2026e	2027e	2028e	Old 2026e	2027e	2028e	% change 2026e	2027e	2028e
Revenue	7,281	7,036	7,045	6,378	6,467	6,829	14%	9%	3%
EBITDA	3,224	3,086	3,053	2,696	2,767	2,961	20%	12%	3%
margin (%)	44%	44%	43%	42%	43%	43%			
Net income	1,364	1,424	1,428	1,088	1,243	1,366	25%	15%	5%
EPS (USD)	4.78	4.98	5.00	3.81	4.35	4.78	25%	15%	5%

Source: HSBC estimates

SQM: Our estimates vs consensus, 2026-28e

USDm, except otherwise noted	HSBC 2026e	2027e	2028e	Cons. 2026e	2027e	2028e	% change 2026e	2027e	2028e
Revenue	7,281	7,036	7,045	7,104	7,531	7,601	2%	-7%	-7%
EBITDA	3,224	3,086	3,053	3,161	3,396	3,379	2%	-9%	-10%
margin (%)	44%	44%	43%	44%	45%	44%			
Net income	1,364	1,424	1,428	1,558	1,714	1,754	-12%	-17%	-19%
EPS (USD)	4.78	4.98	5.00	5.65	6.25	6.10	-15%	-20%	-18%

Source: Bloomberg consensus forecasts, HSBC estimates

Valuation and risks

We value SQM using a sum-of-the-parts approach (see table below), assuming a WACC of 7.3% (unchanged), based on a risk-free rate of 4.25%, country risk premium of 0.4% (unchanged), equity risk premium of 4.00%, levered beta of 1.1, and debt/equity of 30/70 (all unchanged). We value the Chilean lithium, international lithium, and other businesses using NPV.

The increase in our TP is function of higher estimates. Our TP of USD100.00 (from USD95.00) for SQM US implies 15% upside. We maintain our Buy rating on expectations of a re-rating post finalisation of the agreement with Codelco and expected volume growth.

Our TP for the local shares (SQM/B CI, CMP CLP77,588) of CLP85,000 (from CLP80,750) is based on one share per ADR and HSBC FX strategist 2026 EoP forecast of 850 (unchanged).

Sum-of-the-parts approach (USDm)

	USDm
Lithium Chile Division	14,832
International Lithium Division	3,770
Other businesses	16,799
Corporate	(2,562)
EV	**32,838**
Net debt	2,822
Less: non-controlling stake	48
Equity value	**29,969**
No. of shares	286
Fair value/share (USD)	**100.00**

Source: HSBC estimates

Downside risks include extended downcycle affecting cash flows and dividends; ramp up issues in the Covalent lithium refinery project in Australia; material weakness in its other segments; potential policy changes that might change the lithium producing landscape in Chile; and any changes in the proposed agreement with Codelco or delay in finalisation of the agreement.

Financials & valuation: SQM

Buy

Financial statements

Year to	12/2025a	12/2026e	12/2027e	12/2028e
Profit & loss summary (USDm)				
Revenue	4,576	7,281	7,036	7,045
EBITDA	1,580	3,224	3,086	3,053
Depreciation & amortisation	-423	-432	-465	-484
Operating profit/EBIT	1,157	2,792	2,621	2,569
Net interest	-107	-146	-131	-96
PBT	961	2,628	2,477	2,459
HSBC PBT	961	2,628	2,477	2,459
Taxation	-320	-848	-799	-792
Net profit	588	1,364	1,424	1,428
HSBC net profit	588	1,364	1,424	1,428
Cash flow summary (USDm)				
Cash flow from operations	1,314	1,270	1,895	2,017
Capex	-877	-902	-903	-342
Cash flow from investment	-772	-902	-903	-342
Dividends	-4	-176	-409	-427
Change in net debt	-456	-192	-583	-1,248
FCF equity	438	369	993	1,675
Balance sheet summary (USDm)				
Intangible fixed assets	2,554	2,554	2,554	2,554
Tangible fixed assets	5,284	5,754	6,191	6,049
Current assets	5,780	6,576	7,161	8,319
Cash & others	1,750	1,943	2,526	3,774
Total assets	14,505	15,771	16,793	17,809
Operating liabilities	1,321	1,390	1,390	1,396
Gross debt	4,764	4,764	4,764	4,764
Net debt	3,014	2,822	2,238	990
Shareholders' funds	5,691	6,879	7,894	8,895
Invested capital	10,547	11,551	11,991	11,752

Ratio, growth and per share analysis

Year to	12/2025a	12/2026e	12/2027e	12/2028e
Y-o-y % change				
Revenue	1.0	59.1	-3.4	0.1
EBITDA	6.5	104.1	-4.3	-1.1
Operating profit	1.4	141.3	-6.1	-2.0
PBT	-1.4	173.5	-5.8	-0.7
HSBC EPS		132.0	4.4	0.3
Ratios (%)				
Revenue/IC (x)	0.5	0.7	0.6	0.6
ROIC	8.2	17.1	15.1	14.7
ROE	10.8	21.7	19.3	17.0
ROA	5.9	12.7	11.2	10.5
EBITDA margin	34.5	44.3	43.9	43.3
Operating profit margin	25.3	38.3	37.3	36.5
EBITDA/net interest (x)	14.8	22.1	23.6	31.7
Net debt/equity	37.4	30.5	21.8	8.8
Net debt/EBITDA (x)	1.9	0.9	0.7	0.3
CF from operations/net debt	43.6	45.0	84.7	203.6
Per share data (USD)				
EPS Rep (diluted)	2.06	4.78	4.98	5.00
HSBC EPS (diluted)	2.06	4.78	4.98	5.00
DPS	0.00	0.62	1.43	1.50
Book value	19.92	24.08	27.64	31.14

Valuation data

Year to	12/2025a	12/2026e	12/2027e	12/2028e
EV/sales	6.7	4.2	4.2	4.0
EV/EBITDA	19.3	9.4	9.6	9.3
EV/IC	2.9	2.6	2.5	2.4
PE*	42.2	18.2	17.4	17.4
PB	4.4	3.6	3.1	2.8
FCF yield (%)	1.7	1.4	3.9	6.5
Dividend yield (%)	0.0	0.7	1.6	1.7

* Based on HSBC EPS (diluted)

ESG metrics

Environmental Indicators	12/2024a
GHG emission intensity*	93.2
Energy intensity*	214.9
CO_2 reduction policy	Yes
Social Indicators	**12/2024a**
Employee costs as % of revenues	9.7
Employee turnover (%)	17
Diversity policy	Yes

Governance Indicators	12/2025a
No. of board members	8
Average board tenure (years)	[n/a]
Female board members (%)	12.5
Board members independence (%)	25

Source: Company data, HSBC

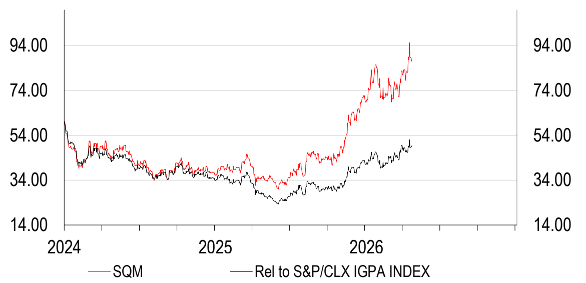
* GHG intensity and energy intensity are measured in kg and kWh respectively against revenue in USD '000s

Issuer information

Share price (USD)	86.95
Target price (USD)	100.00
RIC (Equity)	SQM.N
Bloomberg (Equity)	SQM US
Market cap (USDm)	25,721

Free float	34%
Sector	Agricultural Products
Country/Region	Chile
Analyst	Ishan Jain
Contact	+91 80 4550 3767

Price relative



Source: HSBC

Note: Priced at close of 22 Apr 2026

Albemarle (ALB US, CMP USD194.22) – maintain Buy; increase TP to USD220 (from USD200)

Investment thesis

We believe Albemarle's continuous efforts to control costs and efficiency gains position the company to benefit from higher lithium prices. The company's share price shows high sensitivity to lithium prices. The rise in lithium prices should be helpful in contract negotiations when they are due for rollover in the next 12-18 months.

Sensitivity to changes in lithium prices

Lithium prices are volatile, and the stock price shows a high degree of sensitivity to changes in lithium prices. Approximately 50% of the company's volumes are on a contracted basis. However, it is the long-term outlook on prices that appears to drive volatility in the stock price, as indicated by our sensitivity analysis in the following table.

Sensitivity to changes in lithium price assumptions

	2026e EBITDA USDm	2027e EBITDA USDm	NAV/shr USD	Change vs base case (%) 2026e EBITDA	2027e EBITDA	NAV/shr
20% lower prices	1,854	124.00		-20%	-20%	-44%
10% lower prices	2,088	172.00		-10%	-10%	-22%
Base case	**2,323**	**220.00**				
10% higher prices	2,557	269.00		10%	10%	22%
20% higher prices	2,792	319.00		20%	20%	45%

Source: HSBC estimates

Changes to estimates

The increase in our estimates is function of our higher lithium and spodumene price forecasts.

Albemarle: Our estimate changes, 2026-28e

USDm, except	New			Old			% change		
otherwise noted	2026e	2027e	2028e	2026e	2027e	2028e	2026e	2027e	2028e
Revenue	5,587	5,300	5,317	5,030	5,087	5,293	11%	4%	0%
Adjusted EBITDA	2,323	1,884	1,970	1,847	1,841	1,989	26%	2%	-1%
margin (%)	42%	36%	37%	37%	36%	38%			
Adj net income	870	686	796	534	659	810	63%	4%	-2%
Adj EPS (USD)	7.39	5.83	6.76	4.54	5.60	6.88	63%	4%	-2%

Source: HSBC estimates

Albemarle: Our estimates vs consensus, 2026-28e

USDm, except	HSBC			Cons.			% change		
otherwise noted	2026e	2027e	2028e	2026e	2027e	2028e	2026e	2027e	2028e
Revenue	5,587	5,300	5,317	5,645	5,985	6,324	-1%	-11%	-16%
EBITDA	2,323	1,884	1,970	2,236	2,500	2,657	4%	-25%	-26%
margin (%)	42%	36%	37%	40%	42%	42%			
Net income	870	686	796	1,037	1,280	1,457	-16%	-46%	-45%
Adj EPS (USD)	7.39	5.83	6.76	8.28	9.69	11.08	-11%	-40%	-39%

Source: Bloomberg consensus forecasts, HSBC estimates

Valuation and risks

We value Albemarle using a DCF methodology, assuming a WACC of 7.8% based on a risk-free rate of 4.25%, equity risk premium of 4.00%, country risk premium of 0.5%, levered beta of 1.25. All inputs are unchanged. The increase in our TP is function of higher estimates. Our new target price of USD220 (from USD200) implies 13.3% upside. We have a Buy rating on Albemarle on the back of improving efficiency and higher gearing to rising lithium prices.

Downside risks include delays or unforeseen expenses related to capacity expansion; unexpected production cuts due to inventory pileups and weak demand and pricing; and weakness in other segments**.**

Financials & valuation: Albemarle Corporation

Buy

Financial statements

Year to	12/2025a	12/2026e	12/2027e	12/2028e
Profit & loss summary (USDm)				
Revenue	5,143	5,587	5,300	5,317
EBITDA	1,098	2,323	1,884	1,970
Depreciation & amortisation	-659	-661	-654	-649
Operating profit/EBIT	-367	620	424	609
Net interest	-208	-176	-176	-176
PBT	-308	1,202	847	967
HSBC PBT	-308	1,202	847	967
Taxation	-157	-124	-70	-121
Net profit	-677	870	686	796
HSBC net profit	-93	870	686	796
Cash flow summary (USDm)				
Cash flow from operations	1,282	1,280	1,239	1,310
Capex	-590	-570	-581	-593
Cash flow from investment	-146	90	-581	-593
Dividends	-191	-193	-193	-193
Change in net debt	-709	-980	-382	-484
FCF equity	692	710	657	717
Balance sheet summary (USDm)				
Intangible fixed assets	2,206	1,546	1,546	1,546
Tangible fixed assets	8,612	8,522	8,449	8,393
Current assets	4,008	4,958	5,270	5,741
Cash & others	1,618	2,598	2,980	3,464
Total assets	16,374	16,952	17,401	18,004
Operating liabilities	2,910	2,801	2,747	2,737
Gross debt	3,194	3,194	3,194	3,194
Net debt	2,225	1,246	863	379
Shareholders' funds	9,533	10,210	10,704	11,306
Invested capital	10,299	9,627	9,537	9,479

Ratio, growth and per share analysis

Year to	12/2025a	12/2026e	12/2027e	12/2028e
Y-o-y % change				
Revenue	-4.4	8.6	-5.1	0.3
EBITDA	-3.7	111.5	-18.9	4.6
Operating profit			-31.5	43.5
PBT			-29.5	14.1
HSBC EPS			-21.1	15.9
Ratios (%)				
Revenue/IC (x)	0.5	0.6	0.6	0.6
ROIC	6.1	15.0	11.8	12.2
ROE	-1.0	8.8	6.6	7.2
ROA	-0.9	7.4	5.5	5.6
EBITDA margin	21.4	41.6	35.5	37.1
Operating profit margin	-7.1	11.1	8.0	11.4
EBITDA/net interest (x)	5.3	13.2	10.7	11.2
Net debt/equity	22.8	11.9	7.9	3.3
Net debt/EBITDA (x)	2.0	0.5	0.5	0.2
CF from operations/net debt	57.6	102.8	143.5	345.6
Per share data (USD)				
EPS Rep (diluted)	-5.76	7.39	5.83	6.76
HSBC EPS (diluted)	-0.79	7.39	5.83	6.76
DPS	1.64	1.64	1.64	1.64
Book value	81.02	86.75	90.94	96.06

Valuation data

Year to	12/2025a	12/2026e	12/2027e	12/2028e
EV/sales	4.9	4.4	4.5	4.4
EV/EBITDA	23.1	10.5	12.8	12.0
EV/IC	2.5	2.5	2.5	2.5
PE*	nm	26.3	33.3	28.7
PB	2.4	2.2	2.1	2.0
FCF yield (%)	3.0	3.1	2.9	3.1
Dividend yield (%)	0.8	0.8	0.8	0.8

* Based on HSBC EPS (diluted)

ESG metrics

Environmental Indicators	12/2024a
GHG emission intensity*	228.7
Energy intensity*	898.8
CO_2 reduction policy	Yes
Social Indicators	**12/2024a**
Employee costs as % of revenues	[n/a]
Employee turnover (%)	20
Diversity policy	Yes

Governance Indicators	12/2025a
No. of board members	10
Average board tenure (years)	[n/a]
Female board members (%)	30
Board members independence (%)	90

Source: Company data, HSBC

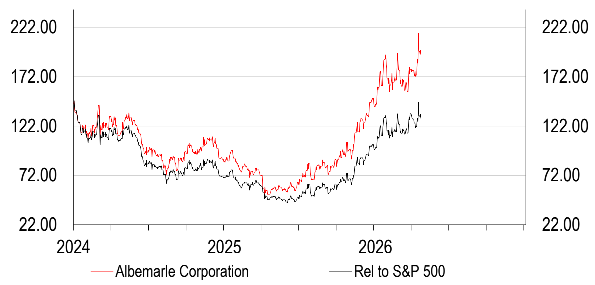
* GHG intensity and energy intensity are measured in kg and kWh respectively against revenue in USD '000s

Issuer information

Share price (USD)	194.22
Target price (USD)	220.00
RIC (Equity)	ALB.N
Bloomberg (Equity)	ALB US
Market cap (USDm)	22,896

Free float	100%
Sector	Chemicals
Country/Region	United States
Analyst	Ishan Jain
Contact	+91 80 4550 3767

Price relative



Source: HSBC

Note: Priced at close of 22 Apr 2026

Lithium Argentina (LAR US, CMP USD9.25) – maintain Buy; increase TP to USD10.25 from USD9.60

Investment thesis

The continuous improvement in production at Cauchari Olaroz indicates operational stability The company has guided for increase in production in 2026 with costs to be around USD6,000/t LCE. In December, Cauchari-Olaroz submitted environmental permit and RIGI applications for a Stage 2 expansion of 45ktpa LCE production capacity, and the company expects to submit the RIGI application for the Pozuelos-Pastos Grandes ("PPG") project in 1Q26. Both projects are coming closer to reality and provide growth optionality.

Sensitivity to changes in lithium prices and WACC

Lithium prices are volatile, and the stock price shows a high degree of sensitivity to changes in lithium prices. Our sensitivity analysis below shows the impact of changes in our lithium price assumptions during the forecasted period (including long-term prices) and WACC on NAV.

Sensitivity of NAV/shr to changes in lithium prices and WACC assumptions

Change in lithium price assumptions	WACC assumptions				
	10.1%	10.6%	11.1%	11.6%	12.1%
20% lower prices	7.40	6.60	5.90	5.30	4.75
10% lower prices	9.95	8.95	8.05	7.30	6.65
Base case	12.50	11.30	**10.25**	9.30	8.50
10% higher prices	15.00	13.60	12.40	11.35	10.40
20% higher prices	17.55	15.95	14.55	13.35	12.30

Source: HSBC estimates

Changes to estimates

We incorporate 4Q25 results, and revisions in our lithium price forecasts. The increase in our 2026 EBITDA estimates reflects higher lithium price assumptions. The cut in our 2026-2027 EPS estimates is due to expectations of higher financial expenses. We introduce 2028 estimates.

Lithium Argentina: Our estimate changes, 2026-28e

USDm, except otherwise noted	New			Old			% change		
	2026e	2027e	2028e	2026e	2027e	2028e	2026e	2027e	2028e
Revenue	-	-	-	-	-				
EBITDA	61	40	38	54	40		13%	-1%	
Net Income	60	48	46	61	51		-3%	-5%	
EPS (USD)	0.37	0.30	0.29	0.38	0.31		-3%	-5%	

Source: HSBC estimates

Valuation and risks

We use an NPV-based valuation approach that assumes a WACC of 11.1% (unchanged) based on a risk-free rate of 4.25%, equity risk premium of 4.00%, country risk premium of 3.4%, and unleveraged beta of 1.2 (all unchanged). We also include the PPG project NPV (derived using same WACC and other assumptions) in our valuation. The increase in our target price is function of higher estimates. Our target price of USD10.25 (from USD9.60) implies 10.8% upside. We have a Buy rating on Lithium Argentina due to growth optionality and potential volatility in lithium prices that skews risk-reward to upside.

Downside risks include production issues leading to suboptimal product quality at Cauchari Olaroz; execution risk that would delay or result in lower-than-expected production and/or cost overruns; lower-than-expected prices affecting economics adversely; macro slowdown resulting in reduced EV sales that could lower demand for lithium; and capital escalation and execution risks at the PPG project.

Financials & valuation: Lithium Argentina AG

Buy

Financial statements

Year to	12/2025a	12/2026e	12/2027e	12/2028e
Profit & loss summary (USDm)				
Revenue	0	0	0	0
EBITDA	-77	61	40	38
Depreciation & amortisation	0	0	0	0
Operating profit/EBIT	-77	61	40	38
Net interest	8	21	26	25
PBT	-76	82	66	63
HSBC PBT	-76	82	66	63
Taxation	0	-22	-18	-17
Net profit	-75	60	48	46
HSBC net profit	-77	60	48	46
Cash flow summary (USDm)				
Cash flow from operations	-30	-17	-8	-8
Capex	0	0	0	0
Cash flow from investment	0	0	0	0
Dividends	0	0	0	0
Change in net debt	50	17	8	8
FCF equity	-30	-17	-8	-8
Balance sheet summary (USDm)				
Intangible fixed assets	0	0	0	0
Tangible fixed assets	350	350	350	350
Current assets	85	68	60	52
Cash & others	61	44	36	28
Total assets	1,100	1,159	1,208	1,254
Operating liabilities	33	33	33	33
Gross debt	237	237	237	237
Net debt	176	193	200	208
Shareholders' funds	768	828	876	922
Invested capital	341	341	341	341

Ratio, growth and per share analysis

Year to	12/2025a	12/2026e	12/2027e	12/2028e
Y-o-y % change				
Revenue				
EBITDA			-34.7	-4.2
Operating profit			-34.7	-4.2
PBT			-19.5	-3.7
HSBC EPS			-19.5	-3.7
Ratios (%)				
ROIC	-22.4	13.0	8.5	8.1
Keu	11.1	11.1	11.1	11.1
EV/IC (x)	4.1	4.0	3.8	3.7
ROIC/Keu (x)	-2.0	1.2	0.8	0.7
REP (x)		3.4	5.0	5.0
ROE	-9.6	7.5	5.6	5.1
EBITDA margin	0.0	0.0	0.0	0.0
Operating profit margin	0.0	0.0	0.0	0.0
Net debt/equity	21.5	22.0	21.7	21.5
Net debt/EBITDA (x)	-2.3	3.2	5.0	5.5
Per share data (USD)				
EPS Rep (diluted)	-0.47	0.37	0.30	0.29
HSBC EPS	-0.47	0.37	0.30	0.29
CFPS	-0.18	-0.11	-0.05	-0.05
DPS	0.00	0.00	0.00	0.00

Valuation data

Year to	12/2025a	12/2026e	12/2027e	12/2028e
EV/EBITDA	nm	22.3	32.9	33.1
PE*	nm	25.1	31.2	32.4
P/CFPS				
P/FCF equity	-50.6	-88.6	-197.6	-187.1
Dividend yield (%)	0.0	0.0	0.0	0.0

* Based on HSBC EPS (diluted)

ESG metrics

Environmental Indicators	12/2024a
GHG emission intensity*	[n/a]
Energy intensity*	[n/a]
CO_2 reduction policy	Yes
Social Indicators	**12/2024a**
Employee costs as % of revenues	[n/a]
Employee turnover (%)	21.1
Diversity policy	Yes

Governance Indicators	12/2025a
No. of board members	8
Average board tenure (years)	[n/a]
Female board members (%)	12.5
Board members independence (%)	62.5

Source: Company data, HSBC

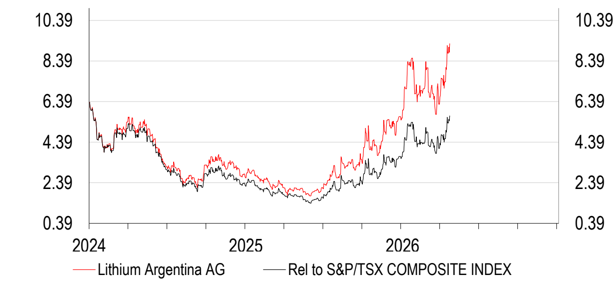
* GHG intensity and energy intensity are measured in kg and kWh respectively against revenue in USD '000s

Issuer information

Share price (USD)	9.25
Target price (USD)	10.25
RIC (Equity)	LAR.N
Bloomberg (Equity)	LAR US
Market cap (USDm)	1,516

Free float	87%
Sector	Metals & Mining
Country/Region	Canada
Analyst	Ishan Jain
Contact	+91 80 4550 3767

Price relative



Source: HSBC
Note: Priced at close of 22 Apr 2026

Lithium Americas (LAC US, CMP USD4.99) – maintain Hold; cut TP to USD4.75 (from USD6.30)

Investment thesis

Lithium Americas has secured financing for the Thacker Pass project, mitigating liquidity risk. That said, we believe the company is still far from its first production and highlight risks arising in the case of capex overruns and delays during the start of the project.

Sensitivity to changes in lithium prices and WACC

Lithium prices are volatile, and the stock price shows a high degree of sensitivity to changes in lithium prices. Our sensitivity analysis showing the impact of changes in our lithium price assumptions during the forecasted period (including long-term prices) and WACC on NAV is shown in the following table.

Sensitivity of NAV/share to changes in lithium prices and WACC assumptions

Change in lithium price assumptions	WACC assumptions				
	7.8%	8.3%	**8.8%**	9.3%	9.8%
20% lower prices	3.20	2.60	2.05	1.65	1.30
10% lower prices	4.90	4.05	3.40	2.85	2.40
Base case	6.55	5.55	**4.75**	4.05	3.50
10% higher prices	8.20	7.05	6.05	5.25	4.60
20% higher prices	9.85	8.50	7.40	6.45	5.70

Source: HSBC estimates

Changes to estimates

We incorporate changes in our lithium price forecasts and FY 25 results in our model. We also increase the share count due to the recent equity issuance and included financial liabilities of USD84m related to LAC warrant obligation and USD150m related to JV warrant obligation. We introduce 2028 estimates.

Lithium Americas: Our estimate changes, 2026-28e

USDm, except otherwise noted	New			Old			% change		
	2026e	2027e	2028e	2026e	2027e	2028e	2026e	2027e	2028e
Revenue	-	36	350	-	34		nm	4%	
EBITDA	(35)	(11)	198	(29)	(6)		nm	nm	
Net Income	(28)	(15)	87	(24)	(12)		nm	nm	
EPS (USD)	(0.08)	(0.04)	0.05	(0.08)	(0.04)		nm	nm	

Source: HSBC estimates

Valuation and risks

We use an NPV-based valuation approach to value Lithium Americas. We assume an average WACC of 8.8% based on a risk-free rate of 4.25%, equity risk premium of 4.00%, and unleveraged beta of 1.25 (all unchanged).

We cut our TP to USD4.75 (from USD6.30) on increase is number of shares and addition of financial liabilities due to the warrants. Our new TP implies 4.8% downside and we maintain our Hold rating due reduced uncertainty with financing secured for the Thacker Pass project.

Downside risks include execution risk that would delay or result in lower-than-expected production and/or cost overruns; lower than-expected prices affecting economics adversely; and macro slowdown resulting in reduced EV sales that could lower demand for lithium.

Upside risks include faster-than-expected execution; and higher-than-expected lithium prices.

Financials & valuation: Lithium Americas Corp

Hold

Financial statements

Year to	12/2025a	12/2026e	12/2027e	12/2028e
Profit & loss summary (USDm)				
Revenue	0	0	36	350
EBITDA	-52	-35	-11	198
Depreciation & amortisation	-1	0	-4	-40
Operating profit/EBIT	-53	-35	-15	158
Net interest	0	-10	-10	-121
PBT	-86	-44	-25	37
HSBC PBT	-86	-44	-25	37
Taxation	0	0	0	-8
Net profit	-122	-28	-15	18
HSBC net profit	-122	-28	-15	18
Cash flow summary (USDm)				
Cash flow from operations	-61	-44	-25	-54
Capex	-765	-1,350	-515	-221
Cash flow from investment	-765	-1,230	-375	-221
Dividends	0	0	0	0
Change in net debt	198	1,205	541	274
FCF equity	-826	-1,394	-541	-274
Balance sheet summary (USDm)				
Intangible fixed assets	0	0	0	0
Tangible fixed assets	1,344	2,694	3,205	3,386
Current assets	912	827	969	761
Cash & others	906	821	955	681
Total assets	2,579	3,844	4,498	4,470
Operating liabilities	460	460	464	407
Gross debt	532	1,652	2,327	2,327
Net debt	-373	832	1,372	1,646
Shareholders' funds	1,059	1,221	1,205	1,223
Invested capital	890	2,240	2,756	3,059

Ratio, growth and per share analysis

Year to	12/2025a	12/2026e	12/2027e	12/2028e
Y-o-y % change				
Revenue				885.9
EBITDA				
Operating profit				
PBT				
HSBC EPS				
Ratios (%)				
ROIC	-8.7	-2.2	-0.6	4.3
Keu	8.8	8.8	8.8	8.8
EV/IC (x)	1.5	1.1	1.1	1.1
ROIC/Keu (x)	-1.0	-0.3	-0.1	0.5
REP (x)				2.3
ROE	-14.4	-2.4	-1.3	1.5
EBITDA margin	0.0	0.0	-31.5	56.5
Operating profit margin	0.0	0.0	-42.8	45.1
Net debt/equity	-23.5	48.0	80.4	94.8
Net debt/EBITDA (x)	7.2	-23.9	-122.6	8.3
Per share data (USD)				
EPS Rep (diluted)	-0.50	-0.08	-0.04	0.05
HSBC EPS	-0.50	-0.08	-0.04	0.05
CFPS	-0.25	-0.13	-0.07	-0.15
DPS	0.00	0.00	0.00	0.00

Valuation data

Year to	12/2025a	12/2026e	12/2027e	12/2028e
EV/EBITDA	nm	nm	nm	17.1
PE*	nm	nm	nm	96.6
P/CFPS				
P/FCF equity	-2.1	-1.2	-3.2	-6.3
Dividend yield (%)	0.0	0.0	0.0	0.0

* Based on HSBC EPS (diluted)

ESG metrics

Environmental Indicators	12/2024a
GHG emission intensity*	[n/a]
Energy intensity*	[n/a]
CO_2 reduction policy	Yes
Social Indicators	**12/2024a**
Employee costs as % of revenues	[n/a]
Employee turnover (%)	[n/a]
Diversity policy	Yes

Governance Indicators	12/2025a
No. of board members	8
Average board tenure (years)	[n/a]
Female board members (%)	25
Board members independence (%)	62.5

Source: Company data, HSBC

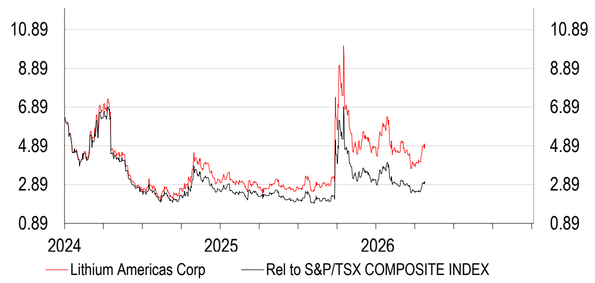
* GHG intensity and energy intensity are measured in kg and kWh respectively against revenue in USD '000s

Issuer information

Share price (USD)	4.99
Target price (USD)	4.75
RIC (Equity)	LAC.N
Bloomberg (Equity)	LAC US
Market cap (USDm)	1,734

Free float	86%
Sector	Metals & Mining
Country/Region	Canada
Analyst	Ishan Jain
Contact	+91 80 4550 3767

Price relative



Source: HSBC
Note: Priced at close of 22 Apr 2026

Disclosure appendix

Analyst Certification

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From 23rd March 2015 HSBC has assigned ratings on the following basis:

The target price is based on the analyst's assessment of the stock's actual current value, although we expect it to take six to 12 months for the market price to reflect this. When the target price is more than 20% above the current share price, the stock will be classified as a Buy; when it is between 5% and 20% above the current share price, the stock may be classified as a Buy or a Hold; when it is between 5% below and 5% above the current share price, the stock will be classified as a Hold; when it is between 5% and 20% below the current share price, the stock may be classified as a Hold or a Reduce; and when it is more than 20% below the current share price, the stock will be classified as a Reduce.

Our ratings are re-calibrated against these bands at the time of any 'material change' (initiation or resumption of coverage, change in target price or estimates).

Upside/Downside is the percentage difference between the target price and the share price.

Prior to this date, HSBC's rating structure was applied on the following basis:

For each stock we set a required rate of return calculated from the cost of equity for that stock's domestic or, as appropriate, regional market established by our strategy team. The target price for a stock represented the value the analyst expected the stock to reach over our performance horizon. The performance horizon was 12 months. For a stock to be classified as Overweight, the potential return, which equals the percentage difference between the current share price and the target price, including the forecast dividend yield when indicated, had to exceed the required return by at least 5 percentage points over the succeeding 12 months (or 10 percentage points for a stock classified as Volatile*). For a stock to be classified as Underweight, the stock was expected to underperform its required return by at least 5 percentage points over the succeeding 12 months (or 10 percentage points for a stock classified as Volatile*). Stocks between these bands were classified as Neutral.

*A stock was classified as volatile if its historical volatility had exceeded 40%, if the stock had been listed for less than 12 months (unless it was in an industry or sector where volatility is low) or if the analyst expected significant volatility. However, stocks which we did not consider volatile may in fact also have behaved in such a way. Historical volatility was defined as the past month's average of the daily 365-day moving average volatilities. In order to avoid misleadingly frequent changes in rating, however, volatility had to move 2.5 percentage points past the 40% benchmark in either direction for a stock's status to change.

Rating distribution for long-term investment opportunities

As of 31 March 2026, the distribution of all independent ratings published by HSBC is as follows:

Buy	59%	(12% of these provided with Investment Banking Services in the past 12 months)
Hold	36%	(12% of these provided with Investment Banking Services in the past 12 months)
Sell	6%	(6% of these provided with Investment Banking Services in the past 12 months)

For the purposes of the distribution above the following mapping structure is used during the transition from the previous to current rating models: under our previous model, Overweight = Buy, Neutral = Hold and Underweight = Sell; under our current model Buy = Buy, Hold = Hold and Reduce = Sell. For rating definitions under both models, please see "Stock ratings and basis for financial analysis" above.

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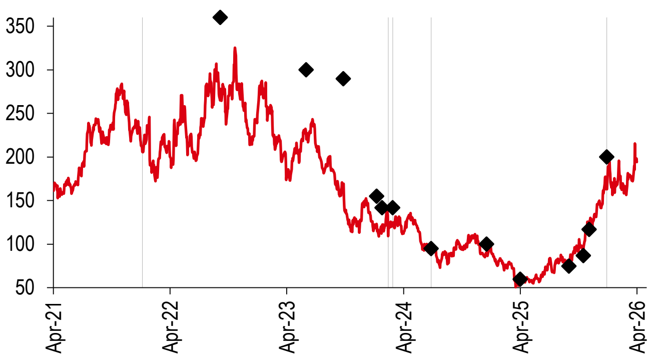
Share price and rating changes for long-term investment opportunities

Albemarle Corporation (ALB.N) share price performance USD Vs HSBC rating history



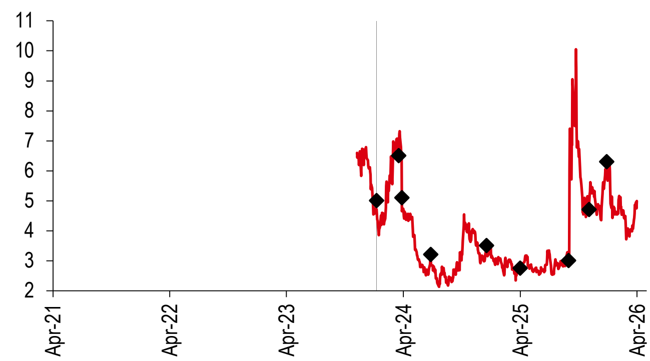
Source: HSBC

Rating & target price history

From	To	Date	Analyst
Hold	Buy	26 Jan 2022	Santhosh Seshadri, CFA
Buy	Restricted	05 Mar 2024	
Restricted	Buy	19 Mar 2024	Santhosh Seshadri, CFA
Buy	Hold	17 Jul 2024	Santhosh Seshadri, CFA
Hold	Buy	18 Jan 2026	Ishan Jain
Target price	**Value**	**Date**	**Analyst**
Price 1	360.00	26 Sep 2022	Santhosh Seshadri, CFA
Price 2	300.00	22 Jun 2023	Santhosh Seshadri, CFA
Price 3	290.00	16 Oct 2023	Santhosh Seshadri, CFA
Price 4	155.00	29 Jan 2024	Santhosh Seshadri, CFA
Price 5	142.00	15 Feb 2024	Santhosh Seshadri, CFA
Price 6	Restricted	05 Mar 2024	
Price 7	142.00	19 Mar 2024	Santhosh Seshadri, CFA
Price 8	95.00	17 Jul 2024	Santhosh Seshadri, CFA
Price 9	100.00	07 Jan 2025	Santhosh Seshadri, CFA
Price 10	60.00	22 Apr 2025	Santhosh Seshadri, CFA
Price 11	75.00	21 Sep 2025	Sriharsha Pappu
Price 12	87.00	06 Nov 2025	Ishan Jain
Price 13	117.00	24 Nov 2025	Ishan Jain
Price 14	200.00	18 Jan 2026	Ishan Jain

Source: HSBC

Lithium Americas Corp (LAC.N) share price performance USD Vs HSBC rating history



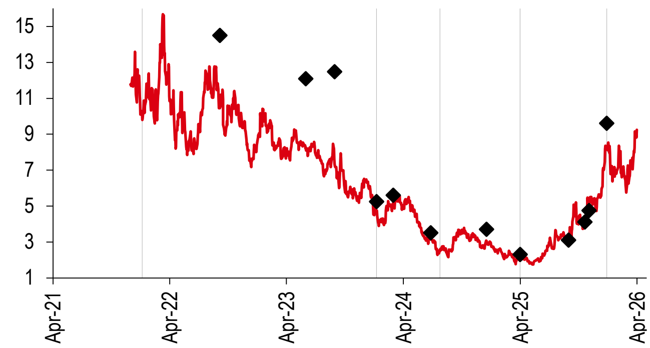
Source: HSBC

Rating & target price history

From	To	Date	Analyst
N/A	Hold	29 Jan 2024	Santhosh Seshadri, CFA
Target price	**Value**	**Date**	**Analyst**
Price 1	5.00	29 Jan 2024	Santhosh Seshadri, CFA
Price 2	6.50	08 Apr 2024	Santhosh Seshadri, CFA
Price 3	5.10	18 Apr 2024	Santhosh Seshadri, CFA
Price 4	3.20	17 Jul 2024	Santhosh Seshadri, CFA
Price 5	3.50	07 Jan 2025	Santhosh Seshadri, CFA
Price 6	2.75	22 Apr 2025	Santhosh Seshadri, CFA
Price 7	3.00	21 Sep 2025	Sriharsha Pappu
Price 8	4.70	24 Nov 2025	Ishan Jain
Price 9	6.30	18 Jan 2026	Ishan Jain

Source: HSBC

Lithium Argentina AG (LAR.N) share price performance USD Vs HSBC rating history



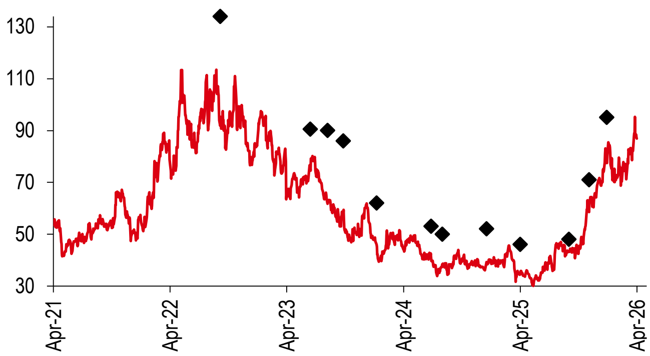
Source: HSBC

Rating & target price history

From	To	Date	Analyst
N/A	Buy	26 Jan 2022	Santhosh Seshadri, CFA
Buy	Hold	29 Jan 2024	Santhosh Seshadri, CFA
Hold	Buy	14 Aug 2024	Santhosh Seshadri, CFA
Buy	Hold	22 Apr 2025	Santhosh Seshadri, CFA
Hold	Buy	18 Jan 2026	Ishan Jain
Target price	**Value**	**Date**	**Analyst**
Price 1	14.49	26 Sep 2022	Santhosh Seshadri, CFA
Price 2	12.08	22 Jun 2023	Santhosh Seshadri, CFA
Price 3	12.48	20 Sep 2023	Santhosh Seshadri, CFA
Price 4	5.25	29 Jan 2024	Santhosh Seshadri, CFA
Price 5	5.60	22 Mar 2024	Santhosh Seshadri, CFA
Price 6	3.50	17 Jul 2024	Santhosh Seshadri, CFA
Price 7	3.70	07 Jan 2025	Santhosh Seshadri, CFA
Price 8	2.30	22 Apr 2025	Santhosh Seshadri, CFA
Price 9	3.10	21 Sep 2025	Sriharsha Pappu
Price 10	4.10	11 Nov 2025	Ishan Jain
Price 11	4.75	24 Nov 2025	Ishan Jain
Price 12	9.60	18 Jan 2026	Ishan Jain

Source: HSBC

SQM (SQM.N) share price performance USD Vs HSBC rating history



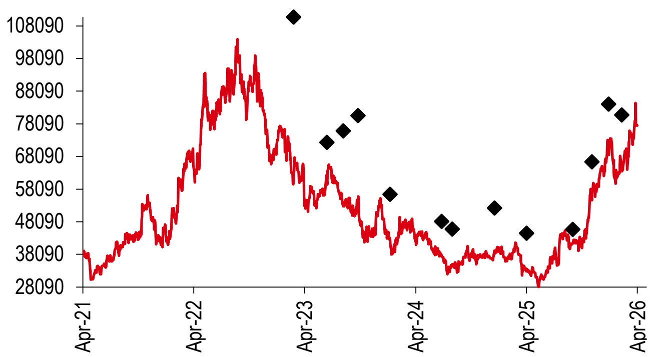
Source: HSBC

Rating & target price history

From	To	Date	Analyst
Reduce	Buy	20 Oct 2020	Alexandre Falcao
Target price	**Value**	**Date**	**Analyst**
Price 1	134.00	26 Sep 2022	Santhosh Seshadri, CFA
Price 2	90.50	05 Jul 2023	Santhosh Seshadri, CFA
Price 3	90.00	28 Aug 2023	Santhosh Seshadri, CFA
Price 4	86.00	16 Oct 2023	Santhosh Seshadri, CFA
Price 5	62.00	29 Jan 2024	Santhosh Seshadri, CFA
Price 6	53.00	17 Jul 2024	Santhosh Seshadri, CFA
Price 7	50.00	21 Aug 2024	Santhosh Seshadri, CFA
Price 8	52.00	07 Jan 2025	Santhosh Seshadri, CFA
Price 9	46.00	22 Apr 2025	Santhosh Seshadri, CFA
Price 10	48.00	21 Sep 2025	Sriharsha Pappu
Price 11	71.00	24 Nov 2025	Ishan Jain
Price 12	95.00	18 Jan 2026	Ishan Jain

Source: HSBC

SQM (SQM_pb.SN) share price performance CLP Vs HSBC rating history



Source: HSBC

Rating & target price history

From	To	Date	Analyst
Reduce	Buy	20 Oct 2020	Alexandre Falcao
Target price	**Value**	**Date**	**Analyst**
Price 1	110738	17 Mar 2023	Santhosh Seshadri, CFA
Price 2	72340	05 Jul 2023	Santhosh Seshadri, CFA
Price 3	75912	28 Aug 2023	Santhosh Seshadri, CFA
Price 4	80550	16 Oct 2023	Santhosh Seshadri, CFA
Price 5	56480	29 Jan 2024	Santhosh Seshadri, CFA
Price 6	48134	17 Jul 2024	Santhosh Seshadri, CFA
Price 7	45787	21 Aug 2024	Santhosh Seshadri, CFA
Price 8	52265	07 Jan 2025	Santhosh Seshadri, CFA
Price 9	44480	22 Apr 2025	Santhosh Seshadri, CFA
Price 10	45700	21 Sep 2025	Sriharsha Pappu
Price 11	66360	24 Nov 2025	Ishan Jain
Price 12	84070	18 Jan 2026	Ishan Jain
Price 13	80750	02 Mar 2026	Ishan Jain

Source: HSBC

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Company	Ticker	Recent price	Price date	Disclosure
ALBEMARLE CORPORATION	ALB.N	194.22	22 Apr 2026	7
LITHIUM AMERICAS CORP	LAC.N	4.99	22 Apr 2026	–
LITHIUM ARGENTINA AG	LAR.N	9.25	22 Apr 2026	–
SQM	SQM.N	86.95	22 Apr 2026	7

Source: HSBC

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